# Balanced V6

## A new CEA link proposal — what would change for you

For discussion · from 1 January 2027 · 26 weeks · code MB-26-V6

# The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

| 35h | 5 | 12 | 30 | 15 min |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **the contracted week, as now** | **most days in a row** | **full weekends off a year** | **days off for 14 days' leave** | **off every closing shift** |
| no extra hours | up to 10 · today 7–9 | today 10 | at best · as today | up to 45 min |

**Same hours, shorter closers, 30 days off for 14 days' leave as now, and never two closing weeks in a row, cover weeks aside.**

# Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it

### A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the new link follows from 1 January 2027.

### More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.

### New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the close and at 22:00. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.

### The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

**The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.**

# Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Contracted days at work a week | 4.20 | **4.19** |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | **218.6** |

**No. The same 35-hour week on average; weeks run 24h 30m–42h 55m Monday to Saturday (today 25h 10m–43h 50m), and two more days a year are Saturdays.**

# Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours — and a swap for a late earns less overtime

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter | 26 | **28** |
| Sunday overtime to share — each, a year | 21 | **20** |
| A late against an early, same day, on average | 32 min longer | **▲ 17 min longer** |
| Finishing at 13:35 or 13:45 — each, a year | 26 | **▲ 20** |

**No. Basic pay stays the same. Premium and overtime pay come to about £200 a year less, gross, if you work your share of Sundays. That assumes no swap overtime.**

# Will my shifts be longer?

Closing shifts get shorter, earlies longer — the average goes up about two minutes

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15 | 8h 40m | ✓ 8h 10m |
| Saturday closers — 15:00 or 15:15, not 14:45 | 9h 10m | ✓ 8h 40m–8h 55m |
| Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30 | 8h 55m | ✓ 8h 10m |
| Average early, Monday to Saturday | 7h 59m | ▲ 8h 06m |
| Average late, Monday to Saturday | 8h 29m | ✓ 8h 24m |
| Average shift, Monday to Saturday | 8h 14m | ▲ 8h 16m |

**Every closing shift is 15 to 45 minutes shorter, and nothing runs over 9 hours.**

# Will I finish late more often?

3 more a year at 23:00 or later (42, today 39); 16 more at 22:00 or later (94, today 78)

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year | 39 | ▲ 42 |
| Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year | 78 | ▲ 94 |
| Starting at 06:20 — each, a year | 62 | 50 |
| Shortest rest between shifts | 12h 30m | ✓ 14h 20m |

**More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; the three more at 23:00 or later are the fewest the rules allow.**

# Will I know the times?

17 shift times in all — 9 of them you already work

## You work these today (9)

06:20–13:35
06:20–13:45
06:20–14:20
06:20–14:50
07:15–15:45
08:00–16:30
13:30–22:00
14:00–22:30
15:15–23:55

## New times (8)

- Closers start later: 30 minutes on weekdays, 15 or 30 on Saturdays, 45 on Sundays
- Weekdays: three 07:30–16:00s handing over to the closers, and a 12:00–20:30
- Weekends: the ticket-office late, 14:30–22:30; on Saturdays a 06:20–15:00
- On Sundays: 09:00–18:00, 9 hours

**Fewer shift times than today (17, not 18) — and today's 13:35, 13:45 and 14:20 stay.**

# Rest and weekends

More weekends off and longer rests, but more single rest days

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Full weekends off, about a year | 10 | ✓ 12 |
| Most days worked in a row | 7 (up to 9) | 5 (up to 10) |
| Rest-day breaks of two days or more | 13 of 17 | ▲ 16 of 27 |
| Shortest rest between shifts | 12h 30m | ✓ 14h 20m |
| Weeks on one shift time, all earlies or all lates | 7 of 16 | ▲ 7 of 21 |

**12 full weekends off a year, at most six weeks apart, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.**

# Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later




**Blocks of earlies or lates up to 3 weeks, 5 if the cover weeks go the same way; a full weekend off comes round at least every six weeks.**

# Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Days off in a row — best place to book | 30 | **30** |
| Days off in a row — on average | 23.4 | **23.5** |
| Days off in a row — worst place | 19 | **19** |
| Leave for four full weeks off, at best | 14 | **14** |

**As today: 14 days' leave buys up to 30 days off, and four full weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday, take 14 days' leave. Average about the same, worst the same.**

# More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, more at 22:00, and more at the close on most days

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| On duty on a weekday | 11–12 | ✓ 15 |
| On duty on a Saturday / Sunday | 10 / 8 | ✓ 14 / 10 |
| Fewest rostered on the floor | 2 | ✓ 3 |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | ✓ 0 (up to 4) |

**At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside.**

# The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

### Eight new shift times to learn

Three later closers, a 07:30 handover, a 12:00 late and three weekend times.

### Earlies or lates in longer runs

Up to 3 weeks of one kind, 5 if the cover weeks go the same way (today 2, up to 3).

### More single rest days, six-day weeks

Eleven in 26 weeks, about 22 a year each (today 10); three six-day weeks (today one).

### Two more Saturdays a year

28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

### More late finishes

42 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39), and 94 at 22:00 or later (today 78).

### Fewer early finishes and long breaks

20 a year each finish before 14:00 (today 26); 6 breaks a year of 3 days or more (today 13).

**None of these is hidden: every figure here is worked out from the rota.**

# At a glance

Same hours and days, shorter closers, more weekends off, fewer days in a row

| | Today | Balanced V6 |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | 35h |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | 218.6 |
| Average shift · longest shift | 8h 14m · 9h 10m | 8h 16m · 9h 00m |
| **Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday** | 8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m | **8h 10m · 8h 40m–8h 55m · 8h 10m** |
| **Full weekends off, about a year** | 10 | **12** |
| **Most days worked in a row** | 7 (up to 9) | **5 (up to 10)** |
| Shortest rest between shifts | 12h 30m | 14h 20m |
| Different shift times | 18 | 17 (9 you know) |
| On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday | 11–12 · 10 · 8 | 15 · 14 · 10 |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | 0 (up to 4) |

**The costs: more late finishes, more single rest days and three six-day weeks.**

# What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell Sara Silva or your manager what worries you, even if it is small
3. Sara Silva, the RMT rep, is leading the change